Jen-Chen Chao

Department of Sociology, Harvard University
504 William James Hall, 33 Kirkland Street
Cambridge, MA 02138

jenchenchao@fas.harvard.edu
jenchenchao.github.io
Updated November 2026

Education

2022–	Ph.D., Sociology, Harvard University Doctoral Trainee in Demography and Population Sciences
2022	M.A., Sociology, National Taiwan University
2020	Visiting Student, University of Wisconsin–Madison
2019	B.A., Sociology, National Taiwan University

Research Interests

Inequality, Education, Social Stratification and Mobility, Gender, Family Demography

Working Papers

1. Jen-Chen Chao. "College Majors, Wage Returns, and Trends in the Gender Wage Gap, 1989–2023." *Under review.*
2. Jen-Chen Chao, Ang Yu, and Felix Elwert. "Do High-Quality Schools Increase Socioeconomic Achievement Gaps? The Roles of Access, Returns, and Selection." *Under review.*
3. Jen-Chen Chao. "Degree of Mobility: School-to-Work Linkages and the Equalizing Power of a College Degree across Fields of Study."
4. Xiang Zhou and Jen-Chen Chao. "Tying the Knot, Climbing the Ladder: How Marriage Shapes Intergenerational Mobility." *Revise and resubmit.*

Research in Progress

1. A paper on the economic returns to some college (with Christina Ciocca Eller, Ohjae Gowen, and Natasha Quadlin)
2. A paper on changing family structure and income inequality (with Xiang Zhou)
3. A paper on college quality and earnings inequality (with Xiang Zhou)
4. A paper on sexuality and punishment (with Sebastian Spitz)
5. A paper on compulsory military service and men's gender attitudes

Selected Conference Presentations

2026	PAA, RC28
2025	PAA, RC28, ASA
2023	PAA

Awards and Honors

2025–2027	Study Abroad Scholarship, Ministry of Education, Taiwan
2022–2026	Scholarship of Government Sponsorship for Overseas Study (Demography), Ministry of Education, Taiwan (declined)
2019–2020	Study Abroad Scholarship for Future Scholars in the Humanities and Social Sciences, Ministry of Education, Taiwan
2018	Dean's List, National Taiwan University

Teaching Experience

Harvard University

Fall 2024–2026	Teaching Fellow, SOCIOL 2202: Intermediate Quantitative Research Methods (required course for sociology Ph.D. students)
Fall 2025–2026	Quantitative Advisor, Department of Sociology
Spring 2025	Teaching Fellow, SOCIOL 1128: Models of Social Science Research

National Taiwan University

Fall 2020–2021	Teaching Assistant, Quantitative Research Methods
Spring 2021	Teaching Assistant, Qualitative Research Methods

Professional Service

2023–2024	Program Development Committee, Doctoral Traineeship in Demography and Population Sciences, Harvard Center for Population and Development Studies
2023–2024	Social Chair, Graduate Student Organization, Department of Sociology, Harvard University
Occasional reviewer	*American Journal of Sociology*, *Demography*, *Population Research and Policy Review*, *Sociological Methods & Research*, *Sociology of Education*

Professional Affiliations

American Sociological Association; Population Association of America; ISA Research Committee 28 on Social Stratification and Mobility; Harvard Institute for Quantitative Social Science; Harvard Center for American Political Studies; UCLA Inequality Data Science Lab; Quantitative Research Lab, Department of Sociology, National Taiwan University